Josh Symonds

Hands-on staff engineer: agent platforms, evals, and LLM infrastructure. Former CISO.
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Built a company-wide agent platform (100+ users, 2,100+ code reviews, 2,170+ alert investigations) and cut code-review cost 16× with production-replay evals. Building with coding agents since 2025; 15 years in infrastructure and security.

Builds with: Go, Python, TypeScript · Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, GCP · Claude Code, MCP, LLM APIs, open-weight models

EXPERIENCE

Attain
Remote — Santa Barbara, CA

Director of SRE, Consumer Product
Mar 2026 - Present

- Marvin: Created Marvin, a company-wide agent platform in Slack for code review, incident investigation, and internal workflows: 116 users across engineering, support, and operations, about 50 weekly active.
- Orchestration: Designed Go/Kubernetes orchestration for ephemeral agent workers on a Nix-built image: per-user OAuth tool credentials, Cedar tool policies, and versioned model routes with provider health checks and one-step rollback.
- LLM Gateway: Launched the company's LLM gateway: SSO-issued keys, request logs, per-person spend, zero-retention providers only. Engineers use two stable model aliases, and we swap in better or cheaper models behind them.
- Code Review: Shipped multi-stage AI code review with a verifier pass that checks findings and drops nitpicks: 2,100+ reviews, 87% positive (300+ ratings).
- Evaluation: Built an evaluation harness that replays production reviews against candidate models, with frozen dev/holdout cases and a version-pinned LLM judge. Blind review found the original verifier wrong on 37% of disputed calls. Moved review to open-weight models: cost per review fell 16× in a month, and median review time halved.
- Incident Investigation: Automated investigation of 2,170+ alert threads: evidence from kubectl, BigQuery, and logs, then escalation or a merge request with the fix, mergeable as written 95% of the time. Tested with synthetic alerts.
- Agent-Ready Monorepo: Made a large fintech monorepo agent-ready with docs, agent skills, and on-demand context loading, shared by Marvin and engineers' local Claude Code sessions.

CrossnoKaye
Santa Barbara, CA

Senior Manager, Core Services / Principal Infrastructure Engineer
Jan 2021 - Feb 2026

- Go Services & Tooling: Built the platform's control plane, its end-to-end testing framework, a local-dev service proxy, and the CLIs engineers used daily across 30+ microservices.
- Edge & Platform: Wrote OS-level provisioning for industrial IoT edge agents and led the migration from k3os to Talos Linux; architected multi-cluster EKS with Flux CD, environment promotion, and rollback.
- AI Enablement: Established Core Services: stood up an internal AI app builder (bolt.diy on Bedrock with Claude), set the org's LLM usage policy, and ran weekly workshops that moved engineering onto AI tooling.

Capital Markets Gateway
Chicago, IL

Senior DevOps Engineer & CISO
Oct 2019 - Dec 2020

- Platform & Security: Developed Kubernetes operators, multi-region failover, and custom Terraform providers; designed NIST CSF and ISO 27001 programs and passed audits by major financial institutions.

M1 Finance
Chicago, IL

Chief Information Security Officer
Aug 2015 - Oct 2019

- Infrastructure & Security: Built greenfield AWS infrastructure that scaled M1 from zero to over a million customers; owned deployment pipelines and the security program; operated bare-metal Kubernetes and led the migration to EKS.

INDEPENDENT ENGINEERING, BUILT WITH CODING AGENTS

Savecraft
Go, TypeScript, Rust, WebAssembly, MCP

- Shipped an AI gaming companion spanning 14 games: open-source Go client with sandboxed WASM parsers; hosted MCP tools behind OAuth 2.1. Raw saves stay local; assistants get structured game state and tools.
- Wrote a Go service pooling LuaJIT processes so agents can test builds on Path of Building's engine (40 ms median).

Gambit & Tiltyard
Claude Code, Go

- Released Gambit, a Claude Code plugin that runs tasks from spec to release in isolated workspaces with test-evidence gates. Tiltyard replays repository tasks to score models and harnesses on correctness, reliability, quality, and cost.

nix-config
NixOS and Home Manager configuration for a nine-host fleet · 837 stars, 118 forks

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Education University of Chicago, BA in East Asian Languages and Civilizations